



Rural idyll

It was not only South Vietnam that tried to win over the rural population. This North Vietnamese scroll, entitled *Nong* (Peasants), from 1960, depicts an idealized scene of farming under communism.

First settlements

Operation Sunrise, the program's pilot project, launched in Binh Duong province, north of Saigon, in March 1962. The plan, administered by Diem's brother, Ngo Dinh Nhu, was to construct five fortified settlements in the Ben Cat district, an area with a strong Viet Cong presence. The project was doomed from the beginning. One of the settlements was so far